

Netherlands

Sovereign government data centre network — capacity, legal posture, provider landscape and migration path.

1 Starting point

Population	18.04 m
GDP	EUR 1,171 bn
Public administration (NACE O)	716 k
Electricity price	199.1 EUR/MWh
Renewables	50.5%
Live hyperscaler regions	2

2 What is structurally different

- Expensive power (199 EUR/MWh vs. EU average ~184). Power is the dominant OPEX line; free cooling, heat reuse, and siting near renewables or nuclear baseload move the economics more than server choice does. The model's power OPEX line is the number to attack first.

3 Capacity

Servers	5,691 (CPU 3,897 / GPU 281 / storage 1,513)
IT critical load	9.4 MW
Facility design load	14.2 MW
Sites	3 (by capacity 2, floor 3)
Average per site	4.7 MW
Site count set by	the minimum-sites floor, not capacity
CAPEX	EUR 339 m
OPEX	EUR 36 m / yr

4 Proposed geography

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
West / Randstad	Primary civil cloud	30%	4.3	High connectivity; avoid overconcentration in Amsterdam proper.
North	Sovereign secondary	20%	2.8	Potential power/land advantages; geographically separated.
East	Government / continuity	20%	2.8	Reduces western concentration risk.
South	Defense / industrial	20%	2.8	Proximity to defense/industrial ecosystem.
Reserve / DR	Strategic reserve	10%	1.4	Expandable reserved capacity.

First-pass geographic hypotheses encoding only the obvious constraints, to be replaced by scored site selection.

5 Legal and regulatory posture

Governing instrument	Rijksbreed cloudbeleid 2022 (revised 2023) permitting public cloud under conditions; Baseline Informatiebeveiliging Overheid (BIO)
Cloud certification	No national cloud scheme; BIO is the binding baseline
Data classification	VIRBI 2013: Departementaal VERTROUWELIJK / CONFIDENTIEEL / GEHEIM / ZEER GEHEIM
Procurement route	SSC-ICT and Rijksinkoop; Logius operates DigiD and the generic services

Foreign jurisdiction exposure. AWS, Azure and Google EU regions including in-country; M365 used under negotiated DPIA conditions after SLM Rijk assessments

Under the US CLOUD Act and FISA 702 a provider subject to US jurisdiction can face a lawful order for data it holds regardless of where that data sits. Residency is necessary but not sufficient; what matters is who holds the keys and who can be compelled.

6 Current state and provider landscape

Government cloud	Soevereine overheidscloud / Rijkscloud - cabinet decision Jul 2026 to build a government-run sovereign cloud hosted in the Overheidsdatacenters (ODC-Noord etc.); first applications end-2026; SSC-ICT and Logius key operators
Maturity	pilot
Digital identity	DigiD (Logius) / eHerkenning / NL Wallet pilot
Interconnection	AMS-IX and NL-ix; landings Egmond/Katwijk/Eemshaven

7 Migration path and cost

Phase	Scope	MW	CAPEX	Cumulative	Hybrid
1	Sovereign core	3.3	EUR 63 m	19%	no
2	Security and defense	4.1	EUR 100 m	48%	no
3	State record	2.5	EUR 63 m	66%	no
4	Elective	4.3	EUR 114 m	100%	yes

Phase 1 is the number that matters: **EUR 63 m** for 3.3 MW, 19% of total CAPEX. That is the floor below which no hybrid arrangement helps — and it is a small fraction of the full build.

8 Geography and threat notes

~26% of land below sea level (Delta works); acute grid congestion (TenneT waiting lists) and Amsterdam-area DC moratoria; nitrogen/land-use constraints; Groningen induced seismicity; gas importer; low geopolitical frontline risk